Wind

The big idea

In this poem by **Subramania Bharati** (translated from Tamil), the poet speaks to the **wind**, which breaks shutters and scatters papers. He says the wind god harms only the **weak**, so we must make our homes, bodies and **hearts strong**. Then the wind will become our **friend**.

Summary

- **Lines 1–7**: The poet asks the wind not to break the window shutters, scatter papers or throw down books from the shelf. He notes how it tears pages and brings rain.
- **Lines 8–11**: He mocks the wind for poking fun at the weak: crumbling houses, doors, rafters, wood, bodies, lives and hearts. The **wind god winnows** them and crushes them all.
- **Lines 12–17**: So let us build **strong homes**, join the doors firmly, practise to **firm the body** and make the **heart steadfast**. Then the wind will be our friend.
- **Lines 18–21**: The wind blows out **weak fires** but makes **strong fires roar and flourish**. His friendship is good; we praise him every day.

SYMBOLISM

The **wind** stands for **difficulties and challenges in life**. They destroy only the weak; the strong grow stronger, like a strong fire fanned by wind.

Poetic devices

Device	Example
Apostrophe	addressing the wind directly: "Wind, come softly."
Personification	the wind is a god who winnows, crushes and can be a friend
Alliteration	"**w**ind god **w**innows"; "**f**riend... **f**ires"
Metaphor	winnowing = separating weak from strong
Repetition	"crumbling... crumbling"
Free verse	no regular rhyme or metre

"WINNOW"

To winnow is to separate grain from chaff by wind. In the poem it means the wind separates and destroys the weak. It does not mean "to win".

Message and values

- Be **mentally and physically strong**; prepare for difficulties.
- Hardships destroy the weak but strengthen the determined.
- Respect nature's power and live in harmony with it.

LIKELY QUESTIONS

What does the wind do in the first stanza? How can we make friends with the wind? What does the poet mean by "the wind blows out weak fires"? Explain "wind god winnows".

Quick recap

- Wind = life's challenges.
- It crushes weak things; strong people befriend it.

- Devices: apostrophe, personification, alliteration, free verse.

Practice questions

1. Who wrote the poem "Wind"?
   (a) Subramania Bharati (b) Rabindranath Tagore (c) Gieve Patel (d) Sarojini Naidu
2. What does the wind symbolise in the poem?
   (a) Happiness (b) Wealth (c) Difficulties in life (d) Friendship only
3. "The wind god winnows" means that the wind
   (a) brings rain to crops (b) separates and destroys the weak (c) wins every battle (d) cleans the house
4. How can we make the wind our friend?
   (a) By closing all windows (b) By praying to it daily (c) By running away from it (d) By building strong homes, bodies and hearts
5. "He makes strong fires roar and flourish" means
   (a) fire is dangerous (b) challenges make strong people stronger (c) the wind is cruel (d) fires should be avoided
6. "Wind, come softly" is an example of
   (a) simile (b) onomatopoeia (c) hyperbole (d) apostrophe
7. What is the poet's message in "Wind"?

Answers: 1. a 2. c 3. b 4. d 5. b 6. d 7. see notes